

Mark Kennedy

About Me

Principal Quality Engineer with 26 years in QA/Testing, currently at Shopify. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Python, Docker and JavaScript.

Academic Background

Bachelor, Biology

Ashford Technical University | 1995 — 1998

GPA 3.8/4.0

Technical Proficiencies

- » Python
- » Docker
- » JavaScript
- » Git
- » CI/CD
- » Jira
- » Java
- » pytest
- » Postman
- » Cypress
- » TypeScript
- » Kafka
- » Redis
- » Bash
- » Hugging Face
- » Sketch

Employment History

Principal Quality Engineer, Shopify

2014-05 — Present

- » Established test data management practices later adopted by 30 teams.
- » Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- » Built a performance harness in Postman simulating 15k concurrent users.
- » Owned release sign-off for 30 services, coordinating across product and support.

Senior Quality Engineer, Stripe

2009-07 — 2014-01

- » Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- » Reduced escaped defects by 15% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- » Drove accessibility coverage from 6% to 82% of core journeys.

Test Automation Engineer

Snowflake | 2003-05 — 2009-06

- » Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 3 hours to 8 minutes through parallelisation.
- » Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 40% to 88%.

Quality Engineer

Nova Tech Group | 1999-04 — 2003-03

- » Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Cypress, catching defects staging had missed.
- » Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.

Language Skills

English – Native

Personal Interests

Open-source contribution, Chess

References available upon request.